

Right Aachen cathedral was built in AD 800 to symbolize the unification and political revival of the West; it is a UNESCO World Heritage site

Below The marinated beef of sauerbraten is served in a rich gravy, sometimes thickened with gingerbread



A Day in Aachen

Aachen's medieval Old Town is easily navigable on foot, but to explore its best museums and spa, you'll need to take a bus.

MORNING Head straight to Aachen's highlight, the **Dom**, which contains Charlemagne's remains in a gilded shrine and a treasury of extraordinary relics. Afterward, amble around the relaxed **Old Town**, visiting the **Rathaus**, whose facade is lined by the figures of 50 Holy Roman Emperors and whose top floor – the **Kaisersaal** (emperor hall) – has 19th-century frescoes and reproduction crown jewels.

AFTERNOON Take a 10-minute bus ride to the **Suermondt-Ludwig-Museum**, an art museum renowned for its stained glass collection and Old Masters such as Albrecht Dürer and Rembrandt. Or head around the corner to the **Ludwig Forum für Internationale Kunst**, a contemporary art museum in an elegant old Bauhaus-style factory.

EVENING Soak in the healing waters Charlemagne once enjoyed at the luxurious **Carolus Thermen** spa.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Cologne/Bonn **airport** lies 45 miles (73 km) and 50 minutes by train from Aachen. High-speed **trains** connect Aachen to Brussels and Paris. There's a good **bus** service around the town.

WHERE TO STAY

Da Salvatore (inexpensive) has simple rooms above an Italian restaurant by the train station. www.zimmer-in-aachen.de

Drei Könige (moderate) is a boutique hotel with brightly colored rooms and apartments in a great central location. www.h3k-aachen.de

Pullman Aachen Quellenhof (expensive) is a grand old hotel with top facilities that backs onto the Carolus spa. www.pullmanhotels.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.aachen.de

